The Hindu qazi had collected funds for the pandit to bathe in the Ganga and wash away his sins, but the young convert showed little appreciation for his efforts. Indeed, he spat in disgust and – here echoing the essence, if not the spirit, of Man Singh's argument against Akbar's 'religion' – declared: 'It is a very strange thing that when any Gentile wishes to become a logue [yogi], or a Mahometan, there is none to stand in his way; but when he wishes to become a Christian, it seems that the Devil and hell are leagued against him, to turn him from his purpose.'

The pandit stuck to his guns, though he had to give up all claims to his inheritance to do so. And so ended 'the most noteworthy episode in the lives of the Christians during the year 1602'. See Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*.

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. See Richards, 'The Formulation of Imperial Authority under Akbar and Jahangir', and Faruqui, 'The Forgotten Prince'.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.